

VITAMIN-M

Class 9 English – Kaveri | Chapter 4 | Asha Nehemiah

Detailed NCERT / Textbook Solutions + Exam Practice

This study pack follows the current Kaveri Chapter 4 sequence and includes the textbook's reading, reflection, vocabulary/structures, listening, speaking, writing and learning-beyond-the-text tasks, followed by additional exam-oriented practice.

Chapter information verified against the current Kaveri Chapter 4 text and exercise sequence. ■cite■turn1view0■turn4view0■

1. CHAPTER INFORMATION

Item	Details
Title	Vitamin-M
Author	Asha Nehemiah
Genre	Humorous family story / realistic fiction
Central situation	Ravi is asked to look after his elderly grandfather, but the day turns into a humorous detective-like chase.
Major characters	Grandpa, Ravi, Vidya (Ravi's mother), Ravi's father
Core ideas	Ageing, dignity, family care, memory, independence, affection, generational understanding, humour

2. CHARACTER SKETCHES

Grandpa

Independent: He dislikes being treated as helpless and wants to retain control over his own life. **Experienced:** His former profession as a lawyer and his knowledge of chess show a sharp, active mind. **Generous:** He gives gifts to the family and even gives his cap to a stranger. **Witty:** His remarks about Vitamin-M and Ravi's detective skills reveal his playful humour. **Affectionate:** He still regards his daughter, son-in-law and Ravi as his 'babies'.

Ravi

Caring: He secretly follows Grandpa to protect him. **Loyal:** He tries to balance his mother's instructions with his grandfather's feelings. **Curious and adventurous:** He turns the outing into a detective mission. **Imperfect but sincere:** He breaks his promise by following Grandpa, yet his motive is concern rather than disobedience.

Vidya / Ravi's mother

Concerned: She worries about her father's safety after his earlier accidents. **Protective:** She asks Ravi not to let Grandpa go out alone. **Busy:** Her work and responsibilities make the situation difficult. **Well-intentioned but overprotective:** She sometimes speaks to Grandpa as though he were a child, which frustrates him.

Ravi's father

He is less prominent, but his reactions provide humour and show that the whole family is involved in caring for Grandpa. He also becomes confused when Grandpa's remarks reveal what happened during the day.

3. IMPORTANT WORDS & MEANINGS

Word	Meaning
frail	physically weak and delicate
shuddered	trembled, usually because of fear or an unpleasant memory
poky	small, cramped and uncomfortable
forbid	to order someone not to do something
pottering	moving or working casually, especially around the house/garden
wincing	showed a brief involuntary reaction to pain, embarrassment or discomfort
dilemma	a difficult situation requiring a choice between alternatives
craftily	cleverly, often in a slightly secretive or cunning manner
furious	extremely angry
boomed	spoke or sounded in a loud, deep voice

Word	Meaning
humiliation	a painful feeling of embarrassment or loss of dignity
attire	clothes or dress
gleam	a small flash or expression of light
nostalgic	having tender feelings for a remembered past
wistfully	with a feeling of gentle longing or sadness

4. READING FOR MEANING – CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Part I

Q1. Why did Grandpa dislike living in the city with his daughter?

He disliked the city because it was noisy, crowded and busy. He missed his quiet brick house, garden and the peaceful surroundings where he had lived independently.

Q2. Why did Vidya not want her father to go out alone?

She was worried about his safety because he had recently taken a double dose of medicine, had once got lost while walking, and had fallen in his garden and remained there all night without help.

Q3. Was Ravi in favour of his mother treating Grandpa like a child? How can you say so?

No. Ravi felt uncomfortable when his mother spoke to Grandpa in an over-loud, childlike manner. He also tried to reassure Grandpa that his mother did not intend to treat him like a baby or prisoner.

Q4. Would Ravi be able to keep up his promise to his mother?

Not literally. Although Ravi promised to stay with Grandpa, he secretly followed him when Grandpa went out. He broke the instruction, but he did so because he was genuinely concerned about Grandpa's safety.

Part II

Q1. Describe Grandpa's day out.

Grandpa left home to get the Tamil newspaper. He visited a children's park, then a tea stall, ate foods forbidden at home, crossed the road, went to a barber shop, gave his cap to a stranger, boarded a bus, and eventually returned home safely.

Q2. Was Grandpa lost as feared by Ravi's mother?

No. Grandpa was not lost. He had returned home safely and was asleep in his bedroom when Ravi came back. Ravi's fear resulted from losing sight of Grandpa during the chase.

Q3. How would Ravi feel after seeing Grandpa?

He would feel relieved, happy and deeply affectionate. His anxiety disappeared when he heard Grandpa snoring safely at home, and he hugged him with affection.

Q4. Do you think Ravi's mother will get to know what had happened?

She receives clues from Grandpa's teasing comments and from Ravi's embarrassed behaviour. However, Grandpa deliberately keeps the details playful rather than exposing Ravi completely.

Part III

Q1. How does Ravi's emotional reaction upon finding Grandpa safe at home reveal his feelings towards his grandfather?

His immediate relief, affection and hug show that he genuinely loves and cares for Grandpa. His earlier decision to follow him also proves that he was worried about his safety.

Q2. What is the significance of Grandpa giving gifts to everyone on his birthday?

It shows that Grandpa expresses affection by giving rather than receiving. He continues to see his adult daughter, son-in-law and grandson as his children and wants to make them happy.

Q3. Why did Grandpa give Ravi a detective story book? What does it suggest?

The book is a humorous clue that Grandpa knew, or strongly suspected, that Ravi had followed him. His remark about 'trailing a suspect' playfully exposes Ravi's secret mission without directly scolding him.

5. CRITICAL REFLECTION – EXTRACT 1

"Grandpa hated the noise and bustle of city life... 'Such a wonderful place...! With that big mango tree in the garden!' ..."

i) Choose the emotion displayed by Grandpa.

Answer: C. Nostalgic. He longs for the peaceful home and garden of his past.

ii) Why did Grandpa hate busy and noisy city life?

Because he preferred the quiet, spacious and peaceful environment of his own house and garden.

iii) Why did Grandpa come to the city despite his dislike?

He had fallen in his garden and remained outside all night because nobody was there to help him. Vidya therefore brought him to the city for safety.

iv) 'You can even hear a leaf fall' means:

Answer: D. Pin-drop silence.

v) One advantage and one disadvantage of living in the town house.

Advantage: Grandpa enjoyed peace, independence and a garden. **Disadvantage:** He was alone, so an accident could leave him without immediate help.

6. CRITICAL REFLECTION – EXTRACT 2

"I had a quiet morning, but I don't know about Ravi. He just disappeared..."

i) Tone of Grandpa's response:

Answer: C. Calm. He speaks coolly and humorously rather than accusing Ravi angrily.

ii) Why was Ravi confused and embarrassed?

He had secretly followed Grandpa, but Grandpa pretended that Ravi had simply disappeared. Ravi therefore feared that Grandpa knew the truth while his mother was asking questions.

iii) Why was Ravi's mother impatient?

She thought Grandpa had forgotten Ravi's birthday and was concerned about his memory.

iv) 'Grandfather forgot that Ravi's birthday was three months ago.' True or False?

Answer: False. Grandpa was talking about his own birthday tradition, not forgetting Ravi's birthday.

v) Why did Grandpa say he did not know what kind of morning Ravi had?

It was a playful reference to Ravi's secret detective mission. Grandpa knew Ravi had not spent the morning quietly at home, even if he did not openly reveal it.

7. CRITICAL REFLECTION – LONGER ANSWERS

Q1. Grandpa is portrayed as a person with failing memory in the beginning. Give two evidences to disprove the statement.

Grandpa can remember thousands of chess games and famous players' moves with remarkable detail. He also remembers his birthday tradition, gives appropriate gifts to every family member and cleverly understands Ravi's behaviour. These details show that his memory is selective rather than simply absent.

Q2. Give two characteristic traits of each character.

Grandpa: independent and witty; generous and affectionate. **Ravi:** caring and loyal; curious and adventurous.

Vidya: protective and responsible; loving but overprotective.

Q3. Why was Ravi worried about what Grandpa had at the tea stall?

Grandpa consumed sugary tea, bananas and ice cream even though these were forbidden at home. Ravi knew his mother would be extremely upset and worried about Grandpa's health.

Q4. Was it easy for Ravi to follow Grandpa?

No. Ravi had to hide in the park, behind a tree and near a car; he was questioned by vendors, accidentally entered a ladies' salon, ran after a bus and nearly followed the wrong man. His mission was difficult and embarrassing.

Q5. 'Ravi is a good detective.' Give one argument for and one against.

For: He observes Grandpa carefully, follows him discreetly and reacts quickly. **Against:** He is repeatedly spotted, gets confused by a stranger wearing a similar cap, and loses track of Grandpa.

Q6. Was Grandpa aware that Ravi was following him?

The ending strongly suggests that he was aware. His detective-book gift and remark about 'trailing a suspect' appear to be a playful acknowledgement of Ravi's actions.

Q7. Who needs Vitamin-M and why?

The story uses 'Vitamin-M' humorously to mean a medicine for memory. Vidya jokingly appears to need it because she forgets Grandpa's birthday. At a deeper level, the story suggests that everyone needs understanding and respect for elderly people rather than simply treating them as helpless.

Q8. Give an example of age-based discrimination.

An elderly person may be ignored during a family decision because others assume that age automatically makes their opinion outdated. Similarly, a young person may be dismissed as inexperienced even when the person has useful knowledge. The story mainly highlights how older people can be denied independence merely because of age.

8. VOCABULARY & STRUCTURES IN CONTEXT

I. Movement words and sound words

Movement words	Sound words
pottering, ducked, evicted, jumping, crawl, twirling, creeping, zigzagging, crouched, thudded, darted, whirled, trailing, crouching, bustle	boomed, bristled, started, thudded, twirled, trailing, crouching, bustle

Detective Shankar – completed passage

1. trailing 2. bustle 3. briskly 4. boomed 5. twirling 6. crouch 7. creeping 8. thudded 9. darted 10. whirr.

II. Synonym family for *jauntily*

Word	Synonyms	Antonyms
jauntily	cheerfully, briskly, lively, confidently	gloomily, sadly, awkwardly

III. Meaning, part of speech, synonym and antonym

Word	Meaning	Part of speech	Synonym	Antonym
craftily	cleverly / cunningly	adverb	cunningly	openly
dilemma	difficult choice/situation	noun	predicament	certainty
furious	extremely angry	adjective	enraged	calm
boomed	spoke/sounded loudly and deeply	verb	thundered	whispered

Word	Meaning	Part of speech	Synonym	Antonym
humiliation	loss of dignity / embarrassment	noun	embarrassment	pride
attire	clothing	noun	dress	undress

IV. Match the emotions/expressions

1–(v) embarrassed = felt uncomfortable; 2–(iv) countered = reply to an argument; 3–(vi) flushed = became red in the face; 4–(i) stricken = affected severely by an unpleasant feeling; 5–(iii) gleam = expression of emotion. Extra meaning: (ii).

V. Prepositions

1. through 2. over 3. near 4. in 5. along 6. towards.

VI. Interrogative sentences and direct speech

A. interrogative B. Yes/No type C. Wh- type D. two types of interrogative sentences. The quoted words are direct speech because they reproduce the speaker's exact words.

VII. Reported speech

1. helped in taking care of her grandparents at home 2. they took turns making sure they were alright 3. if he had grandparents living with him 4. his parents and he visited his grandpa every weekend 5. how they managed their grandparents' medical needs 6. had a schedule for giving medications and visits to the doctor.

9. LISTEN AND RESPOND

Podcast on meditation – answer key

No.	Answer
1	stress management
2	physically and emotionally
3	self-awareness
4	routine
5	exam-related pressure

These answers are reported in current solution references for the teacher-transcript-based listening task.

■cite■turn5search1■turn5search7■

10. SPEAKING ACTIVITY – MODEL RESPONSE

Sample presentation: "The person I had the privilege of taking care of was my grandfather when he was unwell. I helped him with water, medicines and small household tasks. I also spent time talking to him so that he did not feel lonely. This experience taught me patience and responsibility. I realised that elderly people may need physical support, but they also need respect, conversation and independence. Caring for my grandfather made me more understanding and grateful for the experience and wisdom older people bring to a family."

Intonation practice

Wh-questions generally take falling intonation; Yes/No questions generally take rising intonation; choice questions such as "Shall we...or...?" use a rise-fall pattern. Practise the questions from the story accordingly.

11. WRITING TASK – MODEL ARTICLE

OUR INSPIRING ELDERLY

By: A Student of Class IX

Elderly people are an important source of experience, wisdom and emotional strength. Their lives carry lessons that cannot always be found in books. They deserve care, dignity and an opportunity to remain involved in family life.

Grandparents often teach us patience, traditional knowledge, family values and practical skills. They also share stories of difficulties they overcame. Their experiences help younger generations understand how circumstances and society have changed over time.

Many elderly people face health limitations, loneliness or reduced independence, yet they continue to contribute through advice, affection and encouragement. When families listen to them and include them in decisions, older people feel respected and younger members learn empathy and responsibility.

The elderly are not merely people who need care; they are people from whom we can learn. A respectful society should protect their dignity while allowing them as much independence as is safely possible.

12. LEARNING BEYOND THE TEXT

Grandpa's walking stick is described as a beautiful shiny-black mahogany stick with a brass handle carved like an eagle's head. ■cite■turn2view0■

Family-photo activity – model response

Choose one genuine family photograph and record: when and where it was taken, who appears in it, and why the photograph remains memorable. This is intentionally a personal-response activity; students should use their own memories.

13. VERY SHORT ANSWER QUESTIONS

- **Why did Grandpa move to the city?** After a fall and a night spent alone, his daughter brought him to the city for safety.
- **What did Grandpa want to buy?** The Tamil newspaper.
- **What did Ravi secretly do?** He followed Grandpa to make sure he was safe.
- **Where did Grandpa first stop?** At the children's park.
- **What did Grandpa eat at the tea stall?** Sugary tea, bananas and ice cream.
- **Where did Grandpa go next?** To a barber shop and later towards a bus stop.
- **What confused Ravi on the bus?** A stranger wore a similar yellow cap and clothes.
- **Where was Grandpa finally found?** At home, asleep in his bedroom.
- **What gift did Ravi receive?** A hardcover book of detective stories.
- **What does Vitamin-M symbolise?** Humorously, a memory-improving medicine; symbolically, the need for understanding and attentive family care.

14. ADDITIONAL EXAM-ORIENTED QUESTIONS

Q1. How does the story challenge the assumption that old age automatically means helplessness?

The story distinguishes physical limitations from mental ability. Grandpa may need supervision after accidents, but he remains intelligent, independent-minded, generous, humorous and capable of remembering complex chess information. The story therefore encourages respectful support rather than automatic infantilisation.

Q2. Explain the humour in the title 'Vitamin-M'.

Vidya initially jokes that a memory-improving medicine should be invented for old people. Ironically, Grandpa later suggests that Vidya herself needs Vitamin-M because she has forgotten his birthday. The joke reverses the assumption that only elderly people forget things.

Q3. Why is the ending effective?

The ending resolves the mystery, reveals Grandpa's playful awareness, gives Ravi a detective book and turns the chase into a warm family joke. It combines humour with affection and leaves the reader appreciating Grandpa's intelligence.

15. MCQs – CHAPTER PRACTICE

1. Why was Grandpa brought to the city?

- A. He wanted a new job
- B. He had difficulty living safely alone
- C. He disliked his house
- D. He wanted to visit Ravi

Answer: B

2. What did Grandpa dislike most about the city?

- A. Its food
- B. Its weather
- C. Its noise and bustle
- D. Its schools

Answer: C

3. What did Ravi decide to do when Grandpa went out?

- A. Call the police
- B. Follow him secretly
- C. Stay asleep
- D. Go to school

Answer: B

4. Where did Grandpa first stop?

- A. Bus station
- B. Children's park
- C. Market
- D. Hospital

Answer: B

5. Which food was forbidden at home?

- A. Rice
- B. Sugar
- C. Apples
- D. Milk

Answer: B

6. Why did Ravi enter the shop next to the barber shop?

- A. To buy food
- B. To hide
- C. To confront Grandpa
- D. To telephone his mother

Answer: B

7. Whose cap did Ravi mistake for Grandpa's?

- A. A policeman's
- B. A vendor's
- C. A stranger's
- D. His father's

Answer: C

8. What did Grandpa give the stranger?

- A. His walking stick
- B. His yellow cap
- C. His newspaper
- D. His umbrella

Answer: B

9. What did Ravi feel on finding Grandpa safely at home?

- A. Anger
- B. Relief and affection
- C. Boredom
- D. Jealousy

Answer: B

10. What gift did Grandpa give Ravi?

- A. Chess set
- B. Cricket bat
- C. Detective stories
- D. School bag

Answer: C

11. What does Grandpa's gift suggest?

- A. He wanted Ravi to become a lawyer
- B. He knew about Ravi's detective-like pursuit
- C. He disliked Ravi
- D. He wanted Ravi to travel

Answer: B

12. Which trait best describes Grandpa?

- A. Timid
- B. Generous
- C. Careless
- D. Selfish

Answer: B

13. Ravi follows Grandpa mainly because he is—

- A. curious and caring
- B. angry and jealous
- C. bored and lazy
- D. frightened of his mother

Answer: A

14. The phrase 'you can hear a leaf fall' suggests—

- A. rain
- B. silence
- C. danger
- D. winter

Answer: B

15. The story's humour mainly comes from—

- A. a school competition
- B. Ravi's awkward detective mission and Grandpa's wit
- C. a sports match
- D. a family journey abroad

Answer: B

16. ANSWER-WRITING TIP

For 2–3 mark answers, begin with a direct answer, add one or two supporting details from the story, and avoid retelling the entire plot. For longer answers, use a clear point → evidence → explanation structure.